

My Report

Practice message dispatch

Example code :

$3 + 4 * 5$.

$3 + (4 * 5)$.

What I expected : Like in Java, I expected it to follow arithmetic rules and return 23.

What I got : The first expression returned 35, and the second returned 23.

Example code :

$(7 > 5)$ ifTrue: ['big'] ifFalse: ['small'].

What I expected : I thought “if” would be a special language keyword, like in Java.

What I got : “ $(7 > 5)$ ” sends the object “true”, ifTrue: and ifFalse: are just methods defined on the objects true and false.

Conclusion

The small examples helped me see that some things in Pharo don't work like I first thought. With the math example I expected normal rules but it went left to right. With the conditional I expected a special if keyword but I found out it is just messages that true and false can answer. I corrected my ideas by trying code in the Playground and checking the results. This showed me that in Pharo almost everything is done by sending messages.